



SP224 Social Policy Reading List 2025-2026

This reading list was last updated on September 11, 2025 by jane.gingrich@spi.ox.ac.uk

Course level: Undergraduate

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Organising department: Social policy and intervention

A list of tutors eligible to teach this course is at: Contact the courses team

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General information about this course

Syllabus:

The syllabus for this course can be found at (canvas.ox.ac.uk/courses/71424).

Content and structure:

Honour School of Philosophy, Politics & Economics; History & Politics; Human Sciences; & visiting students. The formal syllabus for the course in the Examination Decrees and Regulations is “The nature and development of social policy and welfare states; public, private and informal systems of welfare; welfare regime typologies; and analysis of social policy. The sources, development, organisation, and outcomes of British social policy, with a focus on a number of issues and policy areas from a selection as published in the course handbook’.

Course objectives:

Social policy is concerned with the ways in which different societies understand and respond to the social needs of their populations. Students will study the ‘mechanisms’ and ‘policy logics’ operating in welfare states, and concepts fundamental such as equality, citizenship, and redistribution across socio-economic and ethnic groups, generations, and genders. A key framework for analysis is the ‘mixed economy of welfare’ – the shifts over time in the relative importance of the state, the market, the voluntary sector, and the family. Students will be required to show both theoretical and substantial knowledge of how these issues and themes play out in several substantive policy areas. The course focuses on the UK but seeks to set this experience in comparative perspective, to provide context and to ask further questions about British arrangements.

Teaching Arrangements:

The paper is taught through a combination of weekly tutorials and lectures. Ten 1-hour lectures are delivered by academic staff of the Department of Social Policy and Intervention on a weekly basis during Michaelmas Term and cover a selection of the following topics:

- Introducing Social Policy and the Welfare State
- Worlds of Welfare
- The Changing Nature of the Welfare Mix
- Immigration and Social Policy
- Health and Health Policy
- Poverty and Social Policy
- Labour Market and Disability Policy
- Education Policy
- Old-age Pensions

- Children, Gender and Family Policy
- Disability and social policy
- Social policy analysis (not covered in a stand alone lecture)

The topics not covered in the lecture can be studied in tutorials. Tutorials are provided each term and consist of eight one-hour sessions taught in group of 2s and sometimes 3s. Students will be required to prepare 6 essays (c. 2500 words).

Lecture slides, notes and other materials

Any lecture slides, notes and other materials for this course can be found on the course-specific Canvas site. You can enrol on the course-specific Canvas site via (canvas.ox.ac.uk/courses/71424).

Assessment

Information about assessment can be found at (canvas.ox.ac.uk/courses/71424).

General works and journals

Books

- Alcock, P., Haux, T., May, M. & Wright, S. (eds.) (2022) *The Student's Companion to Social Policy*, 6th ed., Chichester: Wiley-Blackwell
- Daniel Béland (ed.), Stephan Leibfried (ed.), Kimberly J. Morgan (ed.), Herbert Obinger (ed.), Christopher Pierson (ed.). 2021. *The Oxford Handbook of the Welfare State* (2nd edn). Oxford University Press.
- Alcock, P. (2008) *Social Policy in Britain* (4th edition), Basingstoke: Palgrave.
- Baldock, J. Mitton, L., Manning, N. and Vickerstaff, S. (eds.) (2012) *Social Policy* (4th Edition), Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Lister, R. (2010) *Understanding Theories & Concepts in Social Policy*, Bristol: Policy Press.
- Spicker, P. (2011) *How Social Security Works*. Bristol: Policy Press

Topic 1: Introducing Social Policy and the Welfare State

In this first session, we introduce a range of debates about the contested nature and purposes of social policy. Debates about the goals and possibilities of social policy are discussed, with particular reference to different ideological perspectives on welfare, the theories underlying the initial development of welfare states, and the relationship between the welfare state and citizenship, in particular social citizenship.

Sample Questions

1. Discuss different views about the goals or purposes of social policy and possible reasons for them.
2. What factors drove the emergence of the welfare state in the UK?
3. What is social citizenship? To what extent did ideas about social citizenship matter for the development of modern welfare states?

Core and Further Reading

Social policy concepts and approaches

- *Alcock, P., Haux, T., May, M. & Wright, S. (6th eds.) (2022) *The Student's Companion to Social Policy*, 5th ed., Chichester: Wiley-Blackwell (Chapter 1 and part 2 "Key perspectives").
- *Pierson, C. and Leimgruber, M. 2021. "Intellectual Roots of the Welfare State." *The Oxford Handbook of the Welfare State* (2nd edn). Oxford University Press.
- Beland D. and Mahon, R. (2016) *Advanced Introduction to Social Policy*, Northampton: Edward Elgar (ch. 1-2)
- Greer, S. (2010) "How Does Decentralisation Affect the Welfare State? Territorial Politics and the Welfare State in the UK and US", *Journal of Social Policy*, 39(2), 181-201.
- Daly, M. (2011) *Welfare*, Cambridge: Polity Press (chapters 1 and 3).
- Spicker, P. (2014), *Social Policy. Theory and Practice*, Bristol: Policy Press (part 1 and 2).
- Williams F. (1989) *Social Policy: A critical introduction*, Cambridge: Polity Press (Chapter 1, 2 and 7).

The development of the welfare state

- *Alcock, P., Haux, T., May, M. & Wright, S. (6th eds.) (2022) *The Student's Companion to Social Policy*, 5th ed., Chichester: Wiley-Blackwell (Part 3)
- *Part III of the *The Oxford Handbook of the Welfare State* (2nd edn). Oxford University Press.
 - Kuhnle S. and Sander A. (2021) "The Emergence of the Western Welfare State",
 - Pierson C. and Leimgruber M. (2021) "The intellectual roots of the welfare state"
 - Hemerijk and Ronchi, M. (2021). "Recent Developments: Social Investment Reform in the Twenty-First Century."

- *Besche-Truthe, F., Boger T, and Fischer, J. 2025. "Stages, orders & periods of welfare state development: a global sequence analysis of social policy dynamics." *Journal of Public Policy*. 1-28 (firstview)
- Bhambra G. K. (2021) Relations of extraction, relations of redistribution: Empire, nation, and the construction of the British welfare state, *British Journal of Sociology*, 73(1), 4-15.
- Daly, M. (2000) *The Gender Division of Welfare the Impact of the British and German Welfare States*, Cambridge, Cambridge University Press (Chapters 2 and 3)
- Fraser, D. (2017) *The Evolution of the British Welfare State*, 5th ed. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan

Social Policy and Citizenship

- *Marshall, T. H. "Citizenship and Social Class", in Pierson C and Castles F. G. (2000) *The Welfare State Reader*, Cambridge: Polity Press.
- Pateman, C. (1988) "The Patriarchal Welfare State", in Pierson C and Castles F. G. (2000) *The Welfare State Reader*, Cambridge: Polity Press.
- Dwyer, P. (2010) *Understanding Social Citizenship* (2nd edition), Bristol: Policy Press
- Dean, H. (2015) *Social Rights and Human Welfare*, London: Routledge (chapters 1 and 4).
- Lister R. and Hobson B., (2002), "Citizenship", in Hobson, B. , Lewis, J. and Siim, B. *Contested Concepts in Gender and Social Politics*, Cheltenham, Edward Elgar.
- Lister, R., F. Williams, A. Anttonen, J. Bussemaker, U. Gerhard, J. Heinen, S. Johansson, A. Leira, B. Siim, C. Tobí'o, and A. Gavanas (2007), *Gendering Citizenship in Western Europe: New Challenges for Citizenship Research in a Cross-National Context*, Bristol: The Policy Press (chapters 1 and 2).
- Powell, M. (2002). 'The Hidden History of Social Citizenship', *Citizenship Studies*, 6(3), 229-244.

Topic 2: Worlds of Welfare

Approaches to welfare differ not only over time but also across national contexts. This session examines ways to conceptualize cross-national differences through typologies of welfare regimes (ways to group welfare states in 'regimes'), including the fundamental feminist critique to mainstream notions and explanations of the origins of different welfare arrangements.

Sample Questions

1. How typical is the UK today of a liberal welfare regime?
2. Feminist perspectives have profoundly altered conceptions of welfare regimes. Discuss.
3. Does the literature on welfare regimes pay too much attention to cash transfer programs and not enough to services?

Core and Further Reading

Key concepts and typologies

- *Esping-Andersen, G. (1990) *The Three Worlds of Welfare Capitalism*, Cambridge: Polity (particularly chapters 1, 2, 3)
- Esping-Andersen, G. (1999) *Social Foundations of Postindustrial Economies*, Oxford: Oxford University Press (chapters 4 and 5).
- *Arts, W. & Gelissen, J. (2002) 'Three worlds of welfare capitalism or more?', *Journal of European Social Policy*, 1 (2), 137-159
- Alber, J. (1995) "A Framework for the Comparative Study of Social Services", *Journal of European Social Policy*, 5(2), pp. 131-149.
- Bonoli, G. (1997) 'Classifying welfare states: A two-dimension approach', *Journal of Social Policy*, 26(3), 351-372.
- Jensen C. (2008) "Worlds of welfare services and transfers", *Journal of European Social Policy*, 18(2): 151-162.
- *Emmenegger, P. et al. (eds.) (2015) (special issue): '25 years of Three worlds of welfare capitalism', *Journal of European Social Policy*, 25(1)
- Fenger, H. (2007) 'Welfare regimes in central & eastern Europe: incorporating post-communist countries in a welfare regime typology', *Contemporary Issues & Ideas in Social Sciences* 3(2), pp.1-30.
- Ferrera, M. (1996) 'The "Southern model" of welfare in social Europe', *Journal of European Social Policy*, 6(1), 17-37
- Kersbergen, K. van & Vis, B. (2014) *Comparative Welfare State Politics: Development, opportunities & reform*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press (ch. 4).

- Giovanni Bertin, Ludovico Carrino, Marta Pantalone. 2021. "Do standard classifications still represent European welfare typologies? Novel evidence from studies on health and social care." *Social Science and Medicine*. Volume 281.

Feminist critiques of welfare regimes

- *Ciccia R. & Sainsbury D. (2018) 'Gendering welfare state analysis: tensions between care and paid work', *European Journal of Politics and Gender* 1(1-2), 93–109.
- *Lewis, J. (1992) 'Gender & the development of welfare regimes', *Journal of European Social Policy* (3), 159-173
- *Orloff, A. S. (1993) 'Gender and the social rights of citizenship: the comparative analysis of gender relations and the welfare state', *American Sociological Review* 58(3): 303-328;
- Orloff, A.S. (1996) "Gender and the Welfare State", *Annual Review of Sociology*, 22, pp. 51-78.
- Orloff, A.S. and Palier, B. (2009) "The Power of Gender Perspectives: Feminist Influence on Policy Paradigms, Social Science, and Social Politics", *Social Politics: International Studies in Gender, State & Society*, 16(4): 405–412.
- Lewis, J. (2001) 'The decline of the male breadwinner model: implications for work and care', *Social Politics* 8 (2): 152–169.
- Lister, R. (2002) 'The dilemmas of pendulum politics: balancing paid work, care & citizenship', *Economy & Society* 31(4), 520-532
- O'Connor, J. S. (1993) 'Gender, Class and Citizenship in the Comparative Analysis of Welfare State Regimes: Theoretical and Methodological Issues', *The British Journal of Sociology*, 44 (3): 501–18.
- Sainsbury, D. (Ed.). (1994) *Gendering welfare states*, London: Sage (introduction and chapter 1)
- Sainsbury D. (1996) *Gender Equality and Welfare States*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press (chapters 1 and 2).

The politics of welfare regimes

- *Esping-Andersen, G. (1990) *The Three Worlds of Welfare Capitalism*, Cambridge: Polity (chapter 5)
- Bhambra, G. K and Holmwood, J. (2018) "Colonialism, postcolonialism and the liberal welfare state", *New Political Economy*, 23 (5). pp. 574-587.
- Korpi, W. (1983) *The Democratic Class Struggle*, London: Routledge (particularly Chapters 1,2, and 5).
- Kersbergen, K. van & Vis, B. (2014) *Comparative Welfare State Politics: Development, opportunities & reform*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press (ch. 1,2, 3).

- Gingrich, J. (2015) "Coalitions, policies, and distribution: Esping-Andersen's three worlds of welfare capitalism", in J. Mahoney & K. Thelen (eds.) *Advances in Comparative-Historical Analysis*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 67-96.
- Huber E. and Stephens J. (2010) *Development and Crisis of the Welfare State*, University of Chicago Press (chapters 1,2, 5 and 8)
- Hobson, B. and Lindholm, M. (1997) "Collective identities, women's power resources, and the making of welfare states", *Theory and Society*, 26(4), pp. 475-508.
- Iversen T. and Soskice D. (2006) "Electoral Institutions and the Politics of Coalitions: Why Some Democracies Redistribute More than Other", *The American Political Science Review*, 100 (2), pp. 165-181.
- Schmitt, C., Lierse, H., Obinger, H., & Seelkopf, L. (2015) "The global emergence of social protection: Explaining social security legislation 1820–2013", *Politics & Society*, 43(4), 503-524.
- Sainsbury D. (1999) "Gender, Policy Regimes, and Politics" in Sainsbury, *Gender and Welfare State regimes*, Oxford: OUP.
- Béland, D., Cantillon, B., Hick, R., & Greve, B. (2023). Policy Legacies, Welfare Regimes, and Social Policy Responses to COVID-19. In Börner, S., & Seeleib-Kaiser, M. (Eds.). *European Social Policy and the COVID-19 Pandemic: Challenges to National Welfare and EU Policy*. Oxford University Press.

Topic 3: The Changing Nature of the Welfare Mix

This session introduces debates on the welfare mix. It discusses ways in which the role of the state vis-à-vis the market and voluntary sectors and the family/informal care has changed over time in the UK in terms of benefits and services; why; and with what implications. We also look briefly at the 'social divisions of welfare' – not only public, but also fiscal and occupational.

Sample Questions

1. Does the privatisation of finance, provision and regulation have different effects on welfare outcomes?
2. Is public and state-based provision of welfare superior to private and market-based forms of provision?
3. Have recent changes in the welfare mix in the UK resulted more from concerns about efficiency than from concerns about equality.

Core and Further Reading

Key concepts and institutional evolution

- *Burchardt, T. & Obolenskaya, P. (2016) Public & private welfare activity in England, CASEPaper 193, London: CASE, LSE
- *Hills, J. (2011) "The changing architecture of the UK welfare state", *Oxford Review of Economic Policy*, 27 (4): 589–607.
- *Powell, M. (ed.) (2019) *Understanding the Mixed Economy of Welfare*, Bristol: Policy Press (Chapter 1 and 2)
- Alcock, P., Haux, T., May, M. & Wright, S. (eds.) (2022) *The Student's Companion to Social Policy*, 6th edn., Chichester: Wiley-Blackwell (Part IV: Welfare Production and Provision)
- Dowling E. and Harvie D. (2014) "Harnessing the Social: State, Crisis and (Big) Society", *Sociology*, 48(5), pp. 869-886.
- Evers, A. (1995) "Part of the welfare mix: The third sector as an intermediate area", *Voluntas*, 6: 159–182
- Farnsworth, K. (2013) "Bringing corporate welfare in", *Journal of Social Policy*, 42(1): 1-22.
- Naczyk, M. (2018) "Occupational welfare in the United Kingdom: from skill retention tool to social protection only for legitimate social risks", In D. Natali, E. Pavolini and B. Vanhercke (eds.) *Occupational welfare in Europe: Risks, opportunities and social partner involvement*. Brussels: ETUI, pp. 79-102.
- Powell, M. and Barrientos A. (2004) Welfare regimes and the welfare mix, *European Journal of Political Research*, 43(1): 83-105.
- Horn, Alex and Sebastian Kohl. 2024. "Beyond trade-offs: Exploring the changing interplay of public and private welfare provision in old age and health in the historical long-run." *Journal of European Social Policy*.

The politics of marketisation and privatisation

- *Gilbert, N. (2015) "Restructuring the mixed economy of welfare: three modes of privatization, *European Policy Analysis*, 1(1): 41-55
- *Perara, I. (2025). *The Welfare Workforce: Why Mental Health Care Varies Across Affluent Democracies*. Cambridge University Press. Chapter 1.
- Blomqvist, P. (2004) "The choice revolution: Privatization of Swedish welfare services in the 1990s", *Social Policy & Administration*, 38 (2): 139-155.
- Brennan, D., Cass, B., Himmelweit, S. and Szebehely, M. (2012) "The marketisation of care: Rationales and consequences in Nordic and liberal regimes", *Journal of European Social Policy*, 22 (4): 377-391.
- Danson, M., & Whittam, G. (2011) "Scotland's Civic Society v. England's Big Society? Diverging Roles of the VCS in Public Service Delivery", *Social Policy and Society*, 10(3): 353-363.
- Gingrich, J. (2011) *Making Markets in the Welfare State: The politics of varying market reforms*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press (chapter 1).
- Gingrich, J. (2021) "Changing states, changing citizens, changing politics?", In C. Ledoux, K. Shire and F. van Hooren (eds.) *The Dynamics of Welfare Markets: Private pensions and domestic/care services in Europe*. Cham: Palgrave.

Economic and Social outcomes

- *Bach-Mortensen, A. and Montgomery, P. (2019) "Does sector matter for the quality of care services? A secondary analysis of social care services regulated by the Care Inspectorate in Scotland", *BMJ Open*, 2019: 9.
- *Goodair, B and Reeves, A. (2022). "Outsourcing health-care services to the private sector and treatable mortality rates in England, 2013–20: an observational study of NHS privatisation." *Lancet*.
- Burchardt, T., Evans, M. & Holder, H. (2015) "Public policy and inequalities of choice and autonomy", *Social Policy & Administration*, 49(1): 44-67.
- Hogg, E. and Baines, S. (2011) Changing responsibilities and roles of the voluntary and community sector in the welfare mix: A review. *Social Policy and Society*, 10 (3): 341-352.
- Offe C. and Keane J. (1984) "Legitimacy versus efficiency", in Offe and Keane, *Contradictions of the Welfare State*, London: Routledge (chapter 5).
- Petersen, O. H., Hjelm, U., and Vrangbæk, K. (2018) "Is Contracting out of Public Services still the Great Panacea? A Systematic Review of Studies on Economic and Quality Effects from 2000 to 2014", *Social Policy & Administration*, 52:130–157.
- Sandel, M. (2012) *What Money Can't Buy: The moral limits of markets*, London: Allen Lane
- Stone, D. (2001) *Policy Paradox: The Art of Political Decision Making*, W. W. Norton & Co. (part 2)
- Taylor-Gooby, P. (1999) "Markets & motives: implications for welfare", *Journal of Social Policy*, 28(1): 97-114.

Topic 4 Immigration and Social Policy

Immigration is a contested issue in contemporary politics and a key challenge for the future of the European welfare states. This topic introduces dominant discourses and debates surrounding migration and social policy, and critically examines different approaches to the provision of migrants' social rights to migrant. Both perceived and real economic, social and political impacts of migration will be explored.

Sample Questions

1. Is it possible to combine an inclusive welfare state with relatively high levels of immigration?
2. Does immigration erode public support for the welfare state?
3. How adequate are current approaches and concepts used to study social policy for the analysis of immigrants' social rights?

Core and Further Reading

Citizenship, race/immigration, and the welfare state

- Alcock, P., Haux, T., May, M. & Wright, S. (eds.) (2016) *The Student's Companion to Social Policy*, 5th ed., Chichester: Wiley-Blackwell (chapter 32)
- Anthias and Yuval-Davis N. (1993) *Racialized Boundaries*, London: Routledge (particularly, chapters 1 and 2).
- Anderson, B. (2014) *Us & Them? The dangerous politics of immigration control*, Oxford: OUP.
- Baubock, R. (2016) *Migration and Citizenship: Legal Status, Rights and Political Participation*, Amsterdam: Amsterdam University Press (introduction and chapter 1).
- Bommers, M. and Geddes A. (eds.) (2000), *Immigration and Welfare: Challenging the Borders of the Welfare State*, London: Routledge (chapters 1-4)
- Craig, C., Atkin, K., Flynn R. and Chattoo S. (eds.), *Understanding 'Race' and Ethnicity: Theory, History, Policy, Practice*, Bristol: Policy Press.
- Griffiths, M. and C.Yeo. (2021) "The UK's hostile environment: Deputising immigration control", *Critical Social Policy*, 41(4): 521-544.
- Koopmans, R. (2005) *Contested Citizenship: Immigration and Cultural Diversity in Europe*, University of Minnesota Press.
- Meer, N. (2022) *The Cruel Optimism of Racial Justice*, Bristol: Policy Press (particularly chapters 2, 3 and 5).
- Spencer, S. (2011) *The Migration Debate*, Bristol: Policy Press

- Vink, M. and Bauböck, R. (2013) "Citizenship configurations: Analysing the multiple purposes of citizenship regimes in Europe", *Comparative European Politics*, 11, pp. 621–648.
- Williams, F. (1995), "Race/ethnicity, gender and class in welfare states: a framework for comparative analysis", *Social Politics*, 2(2), 127–59

Immigration and the politics of welfare state reform

- Afonso, A., & Devitt, C. (2016) "Comparative political economy and international migration", *Socio-Economic Review*, 14(3), 591-613.
- Banting, K. & Kymlicka, W. (eds.) (2016) *The Strains of Commitment: The political sources of solidarity in diverse societies*, Oxford: Oxford University Press (intro)
- Bhambra, G. K. (2017) "Brexit, Trump, and 'methodological whiteness': On the misrecognition of race and class", *The British journal of sociology*, 68, S214-S232.
- Bhambra, G. K. (2017) "The current crisis of Europe: Refugees, colonialism, and the limits of cosmopolitanism", *European Law Journal*, 23(5), 395-405.
- Calò, F., Montgomery, T and Baglioni S. (2022) "'You have to work... but you can't!': contradictions of the active labour market policies for refugees and asylum seekers in the UK." *Journal of Social Policy*, doi:10.1017/S0047279422000502
- Careja, R., & Harris, E. (2022) "Thirty years of welfare chauvinism research: Findings and challenges", *Journal of European Social Policy*, 32(2), 212-224.
- Evans, G. (2006) 'Is multiculturalism eroding the welfare state? The British case', in K. Banting & W. Kymlicka (eds.) (2006) *Multiculturalism & the Welfare State: Recognition & redistribution in contemporary democracies*, 152-176.
- Gugushvili, D., Ravazzini, L., Ochsner, M., Lukac, M., Lelkes, O., Fink, M., Grand, P. and van Oorschot, W., 2021. Welfare solidarities in the age of mass migration: evidence from European Social Survey 2016. *Acta Politica*, 56, pp.351-375.
- Hantrais, L., Stewart, K. and Cooper, K. (2019) 'Making sense of the social policy impacts of Brexit', *Contemporary Social Science* 14(2), 242-255
- Koning, E. A. (2019) *Immigration and the politics of welfare exclusion: Selective solidarity in Western democracies*, University of Toronto Press (chapter 1).
- Larsen, A. C. (2020) "The institutional logic of giving migrants access to social benefits and services", *Journal of European Social Policy*, 30(1): 48–62.
- Mau, S. & Burkhardt, C. (2009) 'Migration and welfare state solidarity in Western Europe', *Journal of European Social Policy* 19(3), 213–229
- O'Reilly, J., Froud, J., Johal, S., Williams, K., Warhurst, C., Morgan, G. Grey C. et al. (2016) "Brexit: understanding the socio-economic origins and consequences.", *Socio-Economic Review* 14(4), 807-854.
- Österman, M., Palme, J., Ruhs, M. (2019). National Institutions and the Fiscal Effects of EU Migrants. REMINDER Project, Florence, The European University Institute.

Immigrant social rights and outcomes

- Anderson B (2010) "Migration, immigration controls and the fashioning of precarious workers", *Work, Employment and Society*, 24(2): 300–17.
- D'Angelo, A. & Kofman, E. (2018) 'From mobile workers to fellow citizens and back again? The future status of EU citizens in the UK', *Social Policy & Society* 17(2), 331-343
- Koopmans, R. (2010) "Trade-offs between equality and difference: Immigrant integration, multiculturalism and the welfare state in cross-national perspective", *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, 36 (1): 1–26.
- Kofman, E., Phizacklea, A. Raghuram, P, and Sales R. (2000) *Gender and International Migration in Europe Employment, Welfare and Politics*, London: Routledge (chapter 1 and 3).
- Morris, L. (2021) *The Moral Economy of Welfare and Migration: Reconfiguring Rights in Austerity Britain*, McGill-Queen's University Press (chapters 1,2,3).
- Morissens, A., & Sainsbury, D. (2005). 'Migrants' Social Rights, Ethnicity and Welfare Regimes' *Journal of Social Policy*, 34(4), 637-660.
- Sainsbury D. (2012) "Liberal welfare states and immigrants' social rights", in Sainsbury D., *Welfare states and immigrant rights*, Oxford: Oxford University Press, pp. 23-52.
- Lewis, H., Dwyer, P., Hodgkinson, S., & Waite, L. (2014) *Precarious lives: Forced labour, exploitation and asylum*, Bristol: Policy Press, available at: <https://library.oapen.org/handle/20.500.12657/45778> (chapters 1-3).
- Nieuwenhuis, R.; Nelson, K.; Bircan, T.; Burman, S.; Eneroth, M.; Machado, J.; Metzing, M.; Nicaise, I.; Schupp, J. (2019). Migrants' social rights: Evaluating a new approach to collect institutional data for comparative research, Leuven, H2020 InGRID-2 project.
- Sales, R. (2002) 'The deserving and the undeserving? Refugees, asylum seekers and welfare in Britain', *Critical Social Policy*, 22(3), pp. 456–478.
- Shutes, I. (2016) "Work-related Conditionality and the Access to Social Benefits of National Citizens, EU and Non-EU Citizens", *Journal of Social Policy*, 45(4), pp. 691-707.
- Sirriyeh, A. (2015). 'All you need is love and£ 18,600': Class and the new UK family migration rules, *Critical Social Policy*, 35(2), 228-247.
- Platt, L., (2007) *Poverty and ethnicity in the UK*, Bristol, UK: Policy Press.

Topic 5 Health Policy

Historical, economic, political and ideological influences combine to determine the design and operation of a health system. Historic and current challenges facing the UK's National Health Service are considered, to explore determinants and drivers of health policy reform. We consider how a health care system is defined; how the UK system differs from those of other countries; and how policy processes and change are analysed. One focus is how far UK healthcare reforms over recent decades were driven by economic/fiscal and/or political/ideological imperatives. Another is to ask about the fundamental causes of health inequalities and about what policies are effective in reducing them.

Sample Questions

1. To what extent are the labels 'national' 'social' and 'private' still useful in analysing health systems in advanced economies - and to what extent does the current UK NHS retain the essential characteristics of the service designed in 1948?
2. Health inequalities are not best addressed by health policies. Discuss.
3. Given the principle of equal access to health care, how do we make sense of continued health inequalities in NHS systems?

Core and Further Reading

The UK NHS in comparative context

- Baggott R. (2022) "Healthcare", In: Alcock, P., Haux, T., V. McCall & M. May, (eds.) (2022) *The Student's Companion to Social Policy*, 6th ed., Chichester: Wiley-Blackwell
- Baggott, R. (2021) "Disease", *Social Policy and Administration*, <https://doi.org/10.1111/spol.12779>
- Baldock, J. Mitton, L., Manning, N. and Vickerstaff, S. (eds.) (2012) *Social Policy* (4th Edition), Oxford: Oxford University Press (chapter 12 "Health and health policy").
- Bambra, C. (2007) "Going beyond the three worlds of welfare capitalism: regime theory and public health research", *Journal of Epidemiology & Community Health*, 61(12), 1098-1102.
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- Mackenbach, J. & McKee, M. (eds.) (2013) *Successes and Failures of Health Policy in Europe: Four decades of divergent trends and converging challenges*, Buckingham: Open University Press
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Health inequalities and the social determinants of health

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- Bartley, M. (2016) *Health Inequality: An introduction to concepts, theories & methods*, 2nd ed., Cambridge: Polity Press (especially chapters 1-3)
- Kelly-Irving M, Ball WP, Bambra C, Delpierre C, Dundas R, Lynch J, McCartney G, Smith K. [Falling down the rabbit hole? Methodological, conceptual and policy issues in current health inequalities research](#). *Critical Public Health* 2023, **33**(1), 37-47.
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Topic 6: Poverty and Social Policy

Poverty and social exclusion matter because they affect fundamentally both individuals' life chances and the kind of society that everyone lives in. This topic explores these concepts, including issues of definition and measurement. It goes on to discuss approaches to dealing with poverty and key topical issues focusing on recent UK developments such as universal credit and benefit caps for larger families.

Sample Questions

1. Does the capabilities approach resolve the choice between focusing on absolute poverty or relative poverty?
2. Are targeted benefits an effective means to reduce poverty? Explain how the idea that child poverty "is about more than income; it is about a lack of opportunity, aspiration and stability" (DWP, 2011) has informed the evolution of the UK policy towards poor children.

Core and Further Reading

Concepts and measures

- Alcock P. (2006) *Understanding Poverty* (3rd edn). Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan. Ch 1, 5-6
- Atkinson A.B., Cantillon B., Marlier E., et al. (2002) *Social Indicators: The EU and Social Inclusion*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Brady, D. (2009) *Rich democracies, poor people: How politics explain poverty*, Oxford University Press (chapters 1 and 2).
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- Gordon D. (2006) "The concept and measurement of poverty", in: Pantazis C., Gordon D., and Levitas R. (eds), *Poverty and Social Exclusion in Britain*. Bristol: The Policy Press.
- Hick, R. (2012) 'The capability approach: insights for a new poverty focus', *Journal of Social Policy* 41 (2), 291-308
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- Marsh et al (2017) *Poverty: the facts* (6th edn). London: Child Poverty Action Group. Ch 2-4
- Social Metrics Commission (2020) *Measuring poverty 2020*. London: Social Metrics Commission. Available at <https://socialmetricscommission.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2020/06/Measuring-Poverty-2020-Web.pdf>

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Policy design and outcomes

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- Baumberg, B. (2016) "The stigma of claiming benefits: a quantitative study", *Journal of Social Policy*, 45(2): 181-199.
- Brady, D. (2009) *Rich democracies, poor people: How politics explain poverty*, Oxford University Press (chapters 3-6).
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- Marsh et al (2017) *Poverty: the facts* (6th edn). London: Child Poverty Action Group (Ch 10).
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- Spicker, P. (2011) *How Social Security Works*, Bristol: Polity Press (Part III "Benefits" and chapter 21, 23, 24, 25).
- Stewart, K., Reeves, A. and Patrick, R. (2021) "A time of need: Exploring the changing poverty risk facing larger families in the UK", London: CASE, LSE, available at <https://sticerd.lse.ac.uk/dps/case/cp/casepaper224.pdf>

Social divisions and poverty

- Alcock P. (2006) *Understanding Poverty* (3rd edn). Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan. Ch 9-12
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https://www.spi.ox.ac.uk/sites/default/files/Gender_and_poverty_Bennett_and_Daly_final_12_5_14_28_5_14.pdf

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- Howard, M. and Bennet F. (2020) "Payment of Universal Credit for couples in the UK: Challenges for reform from a gender perspective", *International Social Security Review*, 73(4):75-96.
- Kelbert, A. W. (2022) "It Shouldn't Happen Here: Colonial and racial discourses of deservingness in UK anti-poverty campaign", *Critical Social Policy*, 02610183221075960.
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- Machin, R. (2022) "COVID-19 and the temporary transformation of the UK social security system", *Critical Social Policy*, 41(4): 651-662.
- Platt, L. (2007) *Poverty and ethnicity in the UK*. Bristol: Policy Press.

Topic 7: Labour Market Policy

The labour market plays a crucial role in determining individuals' livelihoods as well as income distribution in society. This session examines how and why the state intervenes in the labour market by providing financial support and services to those looking for work and by regulating employment relations. It will also discuss how the norm that everyone who can work should engage in (paid) work has left its mark on labour market policy.

Sample Questions

1. What political factors account for developments in UK labour market policy over time?
2. To what extent, and how, have UK labour market policies in recent years contributed to tackling poverty?
3. What are causes and consequences of the turn towards benefit conditionality and activation under New Labour in the UK?

Core and Further Reading

Governing labour markets: actors and institutions

- *Kenworthy, Lane. 2021 "Employment Promotion" and Patrick Emmenegger and Paul Marx "The Regulation of Employment" in *The Oxford Handbook of the Welfare State*. End Edition. Oxford University Press.
- Boeri, T. & van Ours, J. (2014) *The Economics of Imperfect Labor Markets*, 2nd ed., Princeton: Princeton University Press (chapters 1-3 and 10-12)
- Crouch, C. (1993) *Industrial Relations and European State Traditions*. Oxford: Oxford University Press (Part II).
- Coderre-La Palme C and Greer I (2018) "Dependence on a hostile state: UK trade unions before and after Brexit". In: *Rough waters: European trade unions in a time of crises*, Brussels: ETUI: pp. 245–270.
- *Baccaro L, Howell C (2011) "A common neoliberal trajectory: the transformation of industrial relations in advanced capitalism", *Politics & Society* 39(4), pp.521–63
- Meyer, B. (2016) 'Learning to love the government: trade unions and late adoption of the minimum wage', *World Politics* 68(3), 538-575
- Hall P. and Gingerich D. (2009) "Varieties of Capitalism and Institutional Complementarities in the Political Economy," *British Journal of Political Science*, 39(3), pp. 449–82.
- Rubery, J., Ward, K., Grimshaw, D., & Beynon, H. (2005) "Working time, industrial relations and the employment relationship", *Time & Society*, 14(1), pp. 89-111.
- Spicker, P. (2011) *How Social Security Works*, Bristol: Policy Press. (chapter 20).

- Thelen, K. (2001) “Varieties of labor politics in the developed democracies”, In Hall and Soskice, *Varieties of capitalism: The institutional foundations of comparative advantage*, pp. 71-103.
- Bonoli, G. (2003), “Social policy through labor markets understanding national differences in the provision of economic security to wage earners”, *Comparative Political Studies*, 36(9), pp.1007– 30.

The politics of labour markets and reform trends

- *Bonoli, G. (2013) *The Origins of Active Social Policy*, Oxford: Oxford University Press. (chapters 3 to 5).
- Briken K and Taylor P (2018) “Fulfilling the “British Way”: beyond constrained choice—Amazon workers’ lived experiences of workfare”, *Industrial Relations Journal* 49(5–6): 428–458.
- Chung, H. (2022) “A social policy case for a four-day week”, *Journal of Social Policy*, 51(3), pp. 551-566.
- *Clasen, J., & Clegg, D. (2011) *Regulating the risk of unemployment. National adaptations to post-industrial labour markets in Europe*, Oxford: Oxford University Press (Chapters 1 and 2)
- Clasen, J., Clegg, D. & Goerne, A. (2016) ‘Comparative social policy analysis & active labour market policies: putting quality before quantity’, *Journal of Social Policy* 45(1), pp. 21-38
- Deacon A. and Patrick R. (2011), “A new welfare settlement? The Coalition government and welfare-to-work” in Bochel, H., *The Conservative party and social policy*, Bristol: Policy Press.
- Deeming, C. (2015), “Foundations of the workfare state – Reflections on the political transformation of the welfare state in Britain”, *Social Policy & Administration*, 49(7), pp. 862– 86.
- Grimshaw, D. and Rubery, J (2012) “The end of the UK’s liberal collectivist social model? The implications of the coalition government’s policy during the austerity crisis”, *Cambridge Journal of Economics*, 36(1), pp. 105–126
- Holden, C. (2003) “Decommodification and the workfare state”, *Political Studies Review*, 1(3), 303-316.
- Simoni, M. and Vlandas T. (2021), “Labour market liberalisation and the rise of dualism in Europe as the interplay between governments, trade unions and the economy”, *Social Policy & Administration* 55(4), pp. 637-658.
- Walker, R. & Wiseman, M. (2003) ‘Making welfare work: UK activation policies under New Labour’, *International Social Security Review* 56(1), pp. 3-29
- Wiggan J. and Grover C. (2022) “The politics of job retention schemes in Britain: The Coronavirus Job Retention Scheme and the Temporary Short Time Working Compensation Scheme”, *Critical Social Policy*, <https://doi.org/10.1177/02610183221086515>

Labour market outcomes

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- Bryson, A., Joshi, H., Wielgoszewska, B., & Wilkinson, D. (2020) "A short history of the gender wage gap in Britain", *Oxford Review of Economic Policy*, 36(4), pp. 836-854.
- *Goos, M. & Manning, A. (2007) 'Lousy & lovely jobs: the rising polarization of work in Britain', *The Review of Economics and Statistics* 89(1), pp. 118-133
- Drinkwater, S., Eade, J., & Garapich, M. (2009) "Poles apart? EU enlargement and the labour market outcomes of immigrants in the United Kingdom", *International Migration*, 47(1), pp. 161-190.
- Ingold, J. and Hetherington, D. (2013) "Work, welfare and gender inequalities: an analysis of activation strategies for partnered women in the UK, Australia and Denmark", *Work, Employment and Society*, 27(4), pp. 621-638.
- Leuze, K., & Strauß, S. (2016) "Why do occupations dominated by women pay less? How 'female-typical' work tasks and working-time arrangements affect the gender wage gap among higher education graduates", *Work, Employment and Society*, 30(5), pp. 802-820.
- Prosser T (2016) "Dualization or liberalization? Investigating precarious work in eight European countries", *Work, Employment and Society* 30(6): 949–965.
- Rubery, Jill, Arjan Keizer, and Damian Grimshaw. "Flexibility bites back: the multiple and hidden costs of flexible employment policies." *Human Resource Management Journal* 26.3 (2016): 235-251.

Topic 8 Education Policy

Education reforms have been a key area of policy change in the UK, as part of raising standards, achieving economic competitiveness and tackling social inequalities in educational attainment. This session examines the historical origins and contemporary policy development of education, focusing in particular on contemporary policy approaches emphasising parental choice, the national curriculum and new forms of governance, accountability and policy evaluation. The topic focuses on the countries of the UK, but in a comparative context, especially in relation to educational systems in other OECD countries.

Sample Questions

1. Is individual choice a meaningful concept in schools' policy in the UK today?
2. What has been the impact of education policies on the achievement gap?
3. Why are educational inequalities so difficult to eradicate?

Core and Further Reading

Education policy: concepts and approaches

- Alcock, P. (2008) *Social Policy in Britain* (4th edition), Basingstoke: Palgrave (chapter 12)
- Allmendinger, J., & Leibfried, S. (2003) "Education and the welfare state: the four worlds of competence production", *Journal of European social policy*, 13(1), 63-81.
- Baldock, J. Mitton, L., Manning, N. and Vickerstaff, S. (eds.) (2012) *Social Policy* (4th Edition), Oxford: Oxford University Press (Chapter 11).
- Bailey, P. L., & Ball, S. J. (2016) "The coalition government, the general election and the policy ratchet in education: a reflection on the 'ghosts' of policy past, present and yet to come", in Bochel H. and Powell M. (eds), *The coalition government and social policy: Restructuring the welfare state*, Bristol: Policy Press, pp. 125-149.
- West, A. (2016) 'Education in schools', in P. Alcock, T. Haux, M. May & S. Wright (eds.) *The Student's Companion to Social Policy*, 5th edition, Chichester: Wiley-Blackwell, 365-371
- Chitty, C. (2009) *Education Policy in Britain (Contemporary political studies)*, 2nd edition, Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan (chapters 4-7).
- Exley, S., & Ball, S. J. (2011) "Something old, something new: understanding Conservative education policy", In Bochel H. (ed.) *The conservative party and social policy*, Bristol: Policy Press, pp. 97-118.
- Lupton, R., Thomson, S. & Obolenskaya, P. (2016) 'Schools', in Lupton *et al.* (2016) *Social Policy in a Cold Climate: Policies & their consequences since the crisis*, Bristol: Policy Press, pp. 59-79.
- Powell, M. (1999), *New Labour, new welfare state? The 'third way' in British social policy*, Bristol: Polity Press (chapter 5)

- Willemse, N., & De Beer, P. (2012) "Three worlds of educational welfare states? A comparative study of higher education systems across welfare states", *Journal of European Social Policy*, 22(2), pp. 105-117.

Educational expansion: trends, achievements and challenges

- Ball, S. J. (1993) "Education markets, choice and social class: the market as a class strategy in the UK and the USA", *British journal of sociology of education*, 14(1), 3-19.
- Bhattacharya, A. (2021) "How Much Choice is Enough? Parental Satisfaction with Secondary School Choice in England and Scotland", *Journal of Social Policy*, 1-21. doi:10.1017/S004727942100091X
- Blanden, J and Machin, S. (2004) "Educational inequality and the expansion of UK higher education", *Scottish Journal of Political Economy*, 51: 230-249.
- Busemeyer, M. R. (2014) *Skills and inequality: Partisan politics and the political economy of education reforms in western welfare states*, Cambridge University Press (part 1)
- Gingrich, J., & Ansell, B. (2014) "Sorting for schools: housing, education and inequality", *Socio-Economic Review*, 12(2), 329-351.
- Greener, I., & Powell, M. (2009) "The evolution of choice policies in UK housing, education and health policy", *Journal of Social Policy*, 38(1), 63-81.
- Lee, J.-W and Lee, H. (2016) "Human capital in the long run", *Journal of Development Economics*, 122: 147-169.
- Mayhew, K., Deer, C. and Dua, M. (2004) "The Move to Mass Higher Education in the UK: Many Questions and Some Answers", *Oxford Review of Education*, 30: 65-82.
- Marginson, S. (2018) "Global trends in higher education financing: The United Kingdom", *International Journal of Educational Development*, 58, 26-36.
- Murtin, F., Viarengo, M. (2009) "The Expansion and Convergence of Compulsory Schooling in Western Europe, 1950-2000", *Economica*, 78: 501-522.
- Rowley, K.J. et al. (2019) "Trends in International PISA Scores over Time: Which Countries Are Actually Improving?", *Social Sciences*, 8: 231.

Educational inequality: What role for education policy?

- Anderson, L. R. (2022) *The Future Is Bright – or Is It? Comparing Opportunities Across the Generations in the UK*. SocArXiv. doi:10.31235/osf.io/wx8uz (Chapter 2).
- Boliver, V. (2017) "Misplaced optimism: How higher education reproduces rather than reduces social inequality", *British Journal of Sociology of Education*, 38: 423–432.
- Boliver, V. and Swift, A. (2011) "Do comprehensive schools reduce social mobility?" *British Journal of Sociology*, 62: 89-110.
- Blanden, J. and Macmillan, L. (2016) "Educational Inequality, Educational Expansion and Intergenerational Mobility", *Journal of Social Policy*, 45(4), 589-614.
- Breen, R., Luijkx, R., Muller, W. and Pollak, R. (2010) "Long-term Trends in Educational Inequality in Europe: Class Inequalities and Gender Differences", *European Sociological Review*, 26:31-48.
- Bukodi, E. & Goldthorpe, J.H. (2019) *Social Mobility and Education in Britain. Research, Politics and Policy*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press (Conclusions chapter)

- Bukodi, E., Goldthorpe, J.H. and Zhao, Y. (2021) "Primary and secondary effects of social origins on educational attainment: New finding for England", *British Journal of Sociology*, 72: 627-650.
- Eyles, A., Hupkau, C. and Machin, S. (2016) "Academies, charter and free schools: do new school types deliver better outcomes?", *Economic Policy* 31: 453-501
- Furlong, J. and Lunt, I. (2014) "Inequality and education: continuing the debate", *Oxford Review of Education* 40: 667-679
- Heckman, J. J. (2008) "Schools, skills and synapses", *Economic Inquiry*, 46, 289-324
- OECD. (2017). *Educational Opportunity for All*. Paris: OECD.
- McDaniel, E. and Buchmann, C. (2015) "Gender Inequality in Educational Attainment". In: Scott, R. and Kosslyn, S. (Eds.) *Emerging Trends in the Social and Behavioural Sciences*, John Wiley & Sons.
- Stewart, K. and Waldfogel, J. (2017). *Closing gaps early. The role of early years policy in promoting social mobility in England*. London: Sutton Trust.
- Sturgis, P. and Buscha, F. (2015) "Increasing inter-generational social mobility: is educational expansion the answer?", *British Journal of Sociology*, 66: 512-533.

Topic 9 Old Age Pensions

Old-age pensions are typically the largest item of social expenditure in OECD countries. Demographic change has unsurprisingly been an important driver of pension reform, but it is far from the only factor of importance for the ways in which Western countries have organized their pension systems. This session explores various strategies that countries have used in protecting elderly incomes, some of their main drivers and outcomes in terms of poverty, inequality, and sustainability.

Sample Questions

1. Are recent pension reforms in the UK likely to reduce or increase inequalities amongst pensioners?
2. Do recent changes in pensions policy in the UK threaten intergenerational solidarity?
3. Does population ageing threaten the sustainability of pension systems?

Core and Further Reading

Basics of pension design and reform trends

- Barr, N. & Diamond, P. (2009) "Reforming pensions: principles, analytical errors & policy", *International Social Security Review*, 62 (2): 5-29.
- Barr, N. & Diamond, P. (2009) *Pension Reform: A short guide*, Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Bonoli, G. (2003) "Two worlds of pension reform in Western Europe", *Comparative politics*, 399-416.
- Engelen, E. (2003) "The logic of funding: European pension restructuring and the dangers of financialisation", *Environment and Planning A: Economy and Space*, 35 (8): 1357-1372.
- Hinrichs, K. (2021) "Recent pension reforms in Europe: More challenges, new directions. An overview", *Social Policy & Administration*, 55(3), 409-422.
- Hinrichs, K. & Lynch, J. (2021) "Old-age pensions", In D. Béland, S. Leibfried, K. J. Morgan, H. Obinger & C. Pierson (Eds.) *The Oxford Handbook of the Welfare State*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Immergut, E. M., Anderson, K. M., & Schulze, I. (Eds.). (2007), *The handbook of West European pension politics*, Oxford: Oxford University Press (chapters 1 and 2).
- Korpi, W. (2001). Contentious institutions: An augmented rational-action analysis of the origins and path dependency of welfare state institutions in Western countries. *Rationality and Society*, 13(2), 235–283.

- Pensions Policy Institute (2022) *The Pensions Primer: A Guide to the UK Pension System*, Pensions Policy Institute, <https://www.pensionspolicyinstitute.org.uk/sponsor-research/pensions-primer/>
- Schokkaert, E. & Van Parijs, P. (2003) "Social justice & the reform of Europe's pension systems", *Journal of European Social Policy* 13(3), 245-263
- Spicker, P. (2011) *How Social Security Works*, Bristol: Policy Press. (chapters 15).

Politics of UK pension reform

- Berry, C. (2016) 'Austerity, ageing & the financialisation of pensions policy in the UK', *British Politics* 11(1), 2-25.
- Berry, C. (2021) "The missing politics of UK pensions provision", *The Political Quarterly*, 92 (4), 707-715.
- Bridgen, P., & Meyer, T. (2019) "Divided citizenship: how retirement in the host country affects the financial status of intra-European Union migrants", *Ageing & Society*, 39(3), 465-487.
- Cutler, T. and Waine, B. (2001) "Social insecurity and the retreat from social democracy: Occupational welfare in the long boom and financialization", *Review of International Political Economy*, 8 (1), 96-118.
- Davies, A. (2019) "Pension funds and the politics of ownership in Britain, c. 1970-86", *Twentieth Century British History*, 30 (1), 81-107.
- Hinrichs, K. (2000) "Elephants on the move. Patterns of public pension reform in OECD countries", *European Review*, 8(3), 353-378.
- Meyer, T. & Bridgen, P. (2018) "Individualisation reversed: the cross-class politics of social regulation in the UK's public/private pension mix", *Transfer* 24(1), 25-41.
- Massala, T. & Pearce, N. (2021) "Statecraft and incremental change: Explaining the success of pension reforms in the United Kingdom", *The British Journal of Politics and International Relations*, <https://doi.org/10.1177/13691481211044655>
- Pierson, P. (1994) "Chapter 3: Retrenchment in a core sector: Old-age pensions", In Pierson, P. *Dismantling the Welfare State? Reagan, Thatcher, and the Politics of Retrenchment*. New York, NY: Cambridge University Press.

Inequalities in pension provision

- Brimblecombe, S. & McClanahan, S. (2019) "Improving gender outcomes in social security retirement systems", *Social Policy & Administration* 53(3), 327-342.
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- Gough, O. and Adami, R. (2013) 'Saving for retirement: a review of ethnic minorities in the UK', *Social Policy and Society*, 12(1), pp.147–61.
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- Vlachantoni, A., Feng, Z., Evandrou, M. & Falkingham, J. (2017) "Ethnic elders and pension protection in the United Kingdom", *Ageing & Society*, 37 (5), 1025-1049.

Topic 10 Families, Care and Social Policies

There has been much debate about family change, gender inequality and rising care needs in recent years, and issues of how to support families and carers have risen up the policy agenda, in part due to demographic, and social and economic changes. This topic explores policy approaches towards 'children', 'ageing' and 'care', with a particular focus on debates and policy initiatives relating to children's outcomes, gender inequalities and unmet care needs.

Sample Questions

1. To which extent have childcare policies moved towards a child-centred approach in the UK?
2. Assess the impact of recent reforms of childcare policy on women in the UK.
3. Critically assess the role of choice in recent reforms of adult social care in the UK.

Core and Further Reading

Children, Family Policy and Politics

- Nieuwenhuis R. and Van Lancker, W. (eds.). (2020), *The Palgrave Handbook of Family Policy*, Basingstoke, UK: Palgrave Macmillan.
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- Daly, M. and Ferragina, E. (2018) 'Family policy in high-income countries: five decades of development', *Journal of European Social Policy*, 28(3), pp. 255-270.
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- *Lewis, J. (2006) *Children, Changing Families and Welfare States*, Cheltenham: Edward Elgar (Intro and chapters 3, 4, 6, 9, 12);
- Lewis, J. and West A. (2017) 'Early childhood education and care in England under austerity: continuity or change in political ideas, policy goals, availability, affordability and quality in a childcare market?', *Journal of Social Policy* 46(2), 331-348.
- Fleckenstein T. and Soohyun L. C. (2014) 'The politics of post-industrial social policy: Family policy reforms in Britain, Germany, South Korea, and Sweden', *Comparative Political Studies*, 47(4): 601-30.
- Morgan, Kimberly J. (2022), 'Social Investment or Childcare on the Cheap? Quality, Workforce, and Access Considerations in the Expansion of Early Childhood Education and Care', in Julian L. Garritzmann, Silja Häusermann, and Bruno Palier (eds), *The World Politics of Social Investment: Volume I*, Oxford: Oxford University Press.
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Gender, care and social policy

- *Daly, M. (2010) 'Shifts in family policy in the UK under New Labour', *Journal of European Social Policy* 20(5), pp. 433-443.
- *Daly, M. (2011) 'What adult worker model? A critical look at recent social policy reform in Europe from a gender & family perspective', *Social Politics* 18(1), 1-23;
- Leitner, S. (2003) 'Varieties of familialism: the caring function of the family in comparative perspective', *European Societies* 5(4), 353–375.
- Gillies, V. (2009) 'Understandings and experiences of involved fathering in the UK: exploring classed dimensions', *ANNALS of the American Academy of Political & Social Science*, 624, pp. 49-60.
- Lewis, J. (2009) *Work-Family Balance, Gender & Policy*, Cheltenham: Edward Elgar (chapters 3-5 and conclusions).
- Lister, R. (2006) 'Children (but not women) first: New Labour, child welfare and gender', *Critical Social Policy* 26 (2): 315-335
- Saraceno, C. (2015). A critical look to the social investment approach from a gender perspective. *Social Politics: International Studies in Gender, State & Society*, 22(2), 257-269.
- Kaufman, G. (2017) "Barriers to equality: Why British fathers do not use parental leave", *Community, Work and Family*, 21(3): 310-325.
- Mohun Himmelweit, S. (2023) "Shifting worlds of father politics? Comparing path-departing change in paternity and parental leave policy in Germany and the UK", *Journal of Family Studies*, 29(6), 2556–2575.
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Care, Ageing and Social Policy and Politics

- Daly, M. and Lewis, J. (2000) 'The concept of social care and the analysis of contemporary Welfare States', *British Journal of Sociology*, 51 (2): 281–98.
- Fischer, J., Frisina Doetter, L., & Rothgang, H. (2022). Comparing long-term care systems: A multi-dimensional, actor-centred typology. *Social Policy & Administration*, 56(1), 33-47.
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- Hudson, B. (2021) *Clients, consumers or citizens?: the privatisation of adult social care in England*. Bristol: Policy Press.
- Glasby, J., & Littlechild, R. (2009) *Direct payments and personal budgets: putting personalisation into practice*. Bristol: Policy Press.
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Topic 11: Disability and Social Policy

Social policies aimed at disabled people represent a core feature of modern welfare states. Historically, disability was used as the primary criterion to identify the “deserving poor” and still today disabled people are perceived among the most deserving of public support. Nonetheless, social policies towards disabled people in the UK and elsewhere have undergone far-reaching changes in recent decades and disabled people are today among the groups most at risk of poverty. This session looks at the evolution of social policy towards disabled people in the UK and in comparative perspective, with a particular focus on the shift from paternalistic and medicalized views of disability towards more socially and human rights informed models and its implication for disabled people’s social rights and outcomes.

Sample Questions

1. To what extent does the social model of disability represent a turning point in disability policy?
2. Which political and economic factors explain the evolution of income-support measures towards disabled people in the UK since 2007?
3. Assess the strengths and weaknesses of welfare-to-work policies in relation to the labour market inclusion of disabled people in the UK.

Core and Further Reading

Understanding disability: concepts and approaches

- *Alcock, P., Haux, T., May, M. & Wright, S. (eds.) (2022) *The Student’s Companion to Social Policy*, 6th ed., Chichester: Wiley-Blackwell (chapter 60 Disability)
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- Borsay, A. (2004) *Disability and social policy in Britain since 1750: A history of exclusion*. Basingstoke: Palgrave (particularly, chapter 1 and conclusions).
- Drake, R. F. (1999) *Understanding disability policies*, London: Palgrave (chapters 2-6).
- Harpur, P. (2012) “Embracing the new disability rights paradigm: the importance of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities”, *Disability & Society* 27(1), 1-14.
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- Oliver, M. (2017) “Defining impairment and disability: Issues at stake”, In Emens, E. F., Stein M. A. (eds.), *Disability and equality law*, London, Routledge.

- Priestley, M. (2003) "Disability: A life course approach", Cambridge: Polity.
- Roulstone, A., & Prideaux, S. (2012) *Understanding disability policy*, Bristol: Policy Press.
- Spicker, P. (2011) *How Social Security Works*, Bristol: Policy Press. (chapter 17).
- Stone, D. A. (1986), *The disabled state*, Temple University Press.

Politicizing disability in the welfare state

- *Heffernan, A. (2024). "Disability in Political Science." *Annual Review of Political Science*. 27.
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- Garthwaite, K (2011) "The Language of Shirkers and Scroungers?' Talking about Illness, Disability and Coalition Welfare Reform" *Disability & Society*, 26 (3): 369–372.
- Grover, C., & Piggott, L. (2010) "From Incapacity Benefit to Employment and Support Allowance: social sorting, sickness and impairment, and social security", *Policy studies*, 31(2), 265-282.
- Hyde, M. (2000) "From welfare to work? Social policy for disabled people of working age in the United Kingdom in the 1990s", *Disability & Society*, 15(2), 327-341.
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Social policy design and outcomes

- Bamba, C., Whitehead, M., & Hamilton, V. (2005) "Does 'welfare-to-work' work? A systematic review of the effectiveness of the UK's welfare-to-work programmes for people with a disability or chronic illness", *Social science & medicine*, 60(9), 1905-1918.
- Barnes, C., & Mercer, G. (2005) "Disability, work, and welfare: Challenging the social exclusion of disabled people", *Work, Employment and Society*, 19(3), 527-545.
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- Grover C. and Piggott L. (2015) *Disabled People, Work and Welfare: Is Employment Really the Answer?*, Bristol: Policy Press (chapters 1,2,5,13)
- Patrick, R. (2011) "Disabling or enabling: the extension of work-related conditionality to disabled people", *Social Policy and Society*, 10(3), 309-320.
- Roulstone, A. (2015) "Personal Independence Payments, welfare reform and the shrinking disability category", *Disability and Society*, 30(5), pp. 673-688.
- Shakespeare, T. (2017) *Disability: the basics*, London: Routledge (chapters 5 and 6).

Topic 12: Analysing Social Policy

Social policy analysts seek systematically to investigate social problems, to elucidate and explain the objectives of individual policies and entire welfare systems; to characterise and examine administrative and financial arrangements employed to deliver policies; and to identify, measure and assess the intended and unintended consequences of policy. This session explores some of the key tools used by social policy analysts to explore policy developments in these ways.

Sample Questions

1. What challenges face those attempting to evaluate the impact of social policies?
2. Is it legitimate for policymakers to ignore evidence when evaluating social policies?
3. Why do some issues get on the agenda of governments and others do not?

Core and Further Reading

Key concepts and theoretical approaches

- Cairney, P. (2020) *Understanding Public Policy: Theories & issues* (2nd edition), Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan (chapters 1-5)
- Dussuet, A., & Ledoux, C. (2019) "Implementing the French elderly care allowance for home-based care: Bureaucratic work, professional cultures and gender frames", *Policy and Society*, 38(4), 589-605.
- Meyers, M. K. and Vorsanger, S., (2007) "Street-level bureaucrats and the implementation of public policy", In Peters, B. G., & Pierre, J., *The handbook of public administration*, London: Sage, pp. 153-163.
- Hassel A. and Wegrich K. (2022) *How to Do Public Policy*, Oxford: OUP (Part 1)
- Hupe, P. and Hill M., (2007) "Street-level bureaucracy and public accountability", *Public administration*, 85(2), pp 279-299.
- Howlett, M. (2019) *Designing public policies: Principles and instruments* (2nd edition), London: Routledge (chapters 1,3 and 4).
- Howlett, M., Ramesh, M. & Perl, A. (2020) *Studying Public Policy: Policy cycles and policy subsystems* (4th edition), Oxford: Oxford University Press (chapters 1 and 2).
- Weible, C.M. and Sabatier P.A. (2018) *Theories of the Policy Process*, New York: Routledge (chapters 1,3,5,8).

Agenda-setting and the policy process

- Béland, D., & Howlett, M. (2016) "The role and impact of the multiple-streams approach in comparative policy analysis", *Journal of comparative policy analysis: research and practice*, 18(3), pp. 221-227.
- Béland, D., & Marier, P. (2020) "COVID-19 and long-term care policy for older people in Canada", *Journal of Aging & Social Policy*, 32(4-5), pp. 358-364.
- Birkland, T. A. (2015) *An introduction to the policy process: Theories, concepts, and models of public policy making*, 4th edition, London: Routledge (chapters 1,2 and 6)
- Gedalof, I. (2022) "Eviscerating equality: Normative whiteness and Conservative equality policy", *Critical Social Policy*, 02610183221093788.
- Hall, P. A. (1993) "Policy Paradigms, Social Learning, and the State: The Case of Economic Policymaking in Britain", *Comparative Politics*, 25 (2), 275–96.
- Howlett, M., Ramesh, M. & Perl, A. (2020) *Studying Public Policy: Policy cycles and policy subsystems* (4th edition), Oxford: Oxford University Press (chapters 4, 5, 6, 7).
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- Knill, Christoph, and Yves Steinebach (2022) "What has happened and what has not happened due to the coronavirus disease pandemic: a systemic perspective on policy change." *Policy and Society*, 41(1), pp. 25-39.
- Kuebler, D. (2007) "Understanding the Recent Expansion of Swiss Family Policy: An Idea-Centred Approach", *Journal of Social Policy*, 36(2), 217-237.
- Stone D. A. (1989) "Causal Stories and the Formation of Policy Agendas. Evidence and policy evaluation", *Political Science Quarterly*, 104(2).

Evidence and policy evaluation

- Cairney, P. (2016) *The Politics of Evidence-Based Policy Making*, Basingstoke: Palgrave MacMillan.
- Greve, B. (ed.) (2017), *Handbook of Social Policy Evaluation*, Cheltenham: Edward Elgar (chapters 2 and 8).
- Boaz, A., Davies, H., Fraser, A. & Nutley, S. (2019) *What Works Now? Evidence-informed policy & practice*", Bristol: Policy Press
- Howlett, M., Ramesh, M. & Perl, A. (2020) *Studying Public Policy: Policy cycles and policy subsystems* (4th edition), Oxford: Oxford University Press (chapter 8).
- Monaghan, M., & Ingold, J. (2019) "Policy Practitioners' Accounts of Evidence-Based Policy Making: The Case of Universal Credit", *Journal of Social Policy*, 48(2), 351-368.
- Neuwinger, M. (2021) "The revolution will not be randomized: Universal basic income, randomized controlled trials, and 'evidence-based' social policy". *Global Social Policy*, <https://doi.org/10.1177/14680181211010102>

- Marmot, M. (2004) 'Evidence based policy or policy-based evidence?', *British Medical Journal* 328, pp. 906-907.
- Peters, B. G. (2021) *Advanced introduction to public policy*, Edward Elgar (part 3).
- Spicker, P. (2014) *Social policy: Theory and practice*, Bristol: Policy Press (part 4).
- Stevens, A. (2011) "Telling Policy Stories: An Ethnographic Study of the Use of Evidence in Policy-making in the UK", *Journal of Social Policy*, 40(2), 237-255.
- Wallace, T. (2018) "Policy-driven evidence: Evaluating the UK government's approach to immigration policy making", *Critical Social Policy*, 38(2), 283-301.